How to mix the colour and its shades

One name, several faces. Pink has no stripe of its own in the rainbow. It arises as a lightened red or as a mix of red and white, and so it carries everything from powder pink to fuchsia. **There is no single pink.**

Ready-made tubes have their charm, but **mixing pink teaches you the most**. You will see how white, red and magenta pull against each other, and when a gentle colour turns sugary or, on the contrary, dusty. Start small, on paper, and write down what came from what.

What to prepare



White
The base of all light pink shades.



Red
Depending on its undertone you get a warmer or a cooler pink.



Magenta
A vivid pinkish red for cleaner, brighter mixes.



Yellow or ochre
In small amounts for salmon, peach and earthier tones.



Blue
In tiny doses for a cooler pink close to violet.



Brown
For dusty pink and muted shades.

How can you recognise it without technical names?

The simplest pink is made from white and a small amount of red. **The result will not be the same with every red.** A red with an orange tint can lead you to salmon, while a red close to magenta leads rather to a cooler pink.

When a pigment already has an earthy or orange undertone, **white does not remove it, it only lightens it**. A muted brick can turn into a beautiful skin tone, but not into a sharp pink like a highlighter. For very vivid pinks, start with magenta or a ready-made pink pigment. You will not mix a fluorescent pink just by adding white.

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What the additions do



White

Lightens to powdery and soft. Add it little by little, or start with white.





Magenta

Shifts toward cooler and more saturated. Add it by the tip of the brush, it can take over the whole mix.





Red

Shifts toward warmer, raspberry. Watch out for an orange tint.





Yellow

Shifts toward salmon and peach. Really just the tip of the brush.





Brown

Dusty and muted tones. Too much brown turns it into a dirty beige.





Blue

Shifts toward a cool pink close to violet. Add it in drops.



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Ten pinks to try

A part can be a drop or an equally large dab of paint. **Treat the proportions as a starting point** for experimenting, not as a guarantee of the same shade with every brand.

Light pink



8 parts white and 1 part red. Soft, powdery, clean.

Soft cooler pink



5 parts white and 1 part magenta. Fresh and a little cool.

Saturated pink



3 parts magenta and 1 part white, adding the white gradually. Bold and clean.

Warm salmon



3 parts white and 1 part red, plus a tiny trace of yellow. Warm and soft.

Peach



5 parts white and 1 part red, with a little less yellow still. Summery and light.

Old rose



4 parts pink and a trace of brown, adjust the lightness with white. Quiet and a little nostalgic.

Dusty pink



4 parts pink and a tiny trace of green. Faded, like an old fabric.

Pink with a violet tint



3 parts white, 1 part magenta and a drop of blue. Dreamy and a little cool.

Raspberry



2 parts magenta and 1 part red, a bit of white as needed. Juicy and vivid.

Earthy pink



3 parts white, 1 part red and a trace of ochre or burnt sienna. Calm and natural.

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